

Incident: Allergen Near-Miss, Table 12

Document owner: Grace Liu (FOH Lead)

1) Incident Summary (Original, unedited)

- A salad with candied pecans was plated for a guest with a tree-nut allergy. Expo caught it at the pass because the ticket was flagged ALLERGY.
- Root cause: the modifier printed on a second line and was missed at garde manger.
- Fix: POS modifier moved to the top line in bold; allergen SOP refresher at pre-shift.

2) Purpose and Scope

- Prevent any allergen reaching a guest when an order is flagged ALLERGY.
- Standardize FOH steps from greeting to handoff at the pass.
- Clarify expo checks and communication with garde manger and the rest of the line.
- Applies to all Front of House staff: servers, runners, expo, hosts; interfaces with all stations.

3) Immediate Response Procedure (when an ALLERGY is declared)

1) Acknowledge: Repeat back the allergy to the guest. Example: "Noted—tree-nut allergy." 2) Clarify: Ask what happens on exposure and confirm cross-contact sensitivity. 3) Mark POS: Use the ALLERGY modifier; itemize the specific allergen in the modifier notes. 4) Verbally call: At send, call "ALLERGY: [item], [allergen]" to expo. 5) Allergen ticket: Hand the printed chit to expo; do not park it anywhere else. 6) Runner plan: Assign a runner; runner repeats back the allergy to expo. 7) Final verify at pass: Expo reads ticket and plate label out loud; FOH confirms. 8) Table drop: Server repeats the allergy on drop. No garnish swaps at the table, ever. 9) Follow-up: Check back early; confirm guest is safe and satisfied.

4) POS Entry Standards (to prevent missed modifiers)

- Always select the global ALLERGY modifier plus type the specific allergen (e.g., "tree nuts").
- One ALLERGY per allergic guest; list affected items clearly.
- Do not bury the allergen note in free text; use the standard modifier first.
- Confirm the modifier preview shows at the very top line in bold before sending.
- If the ALLERGY is not showing on top or looks split across lines, stop and alert expo to reprint before the kitchen starts the dish.

- Never ring “no nuts” without the ALLERGY flag.

5) Expo and Pass Checks (Zero-Miss Checklist)

- Ticket shows ALLERGY on the top line in bold, legible, not cut off.
- Read-back: Expo states, “ALLERGY—[allergen]—[item], no [garnish/allergen].”
- Visual scan: Compare plate to the no-go list for that allergen (see table below).
- Garnish audit: Confirm no secondary garnishes or dusts that could contain the allergen.
- Separate landing: Place allergy plates on a clean, designated pass zone.
- Runner confirmation: Runner repeats the allergen back to expo before leaving the pass.

6) Allergen Callouts and Common Risk Garnishes

Allergen callout (FOH)	Common risk on salads/apps	Hidden sources to ask BOH about
Tree nuts	Candied pecans, almonds, walnuts	Pesto, romesco, nut oils, crumble mixes
Peanuts	Peanut crumble, satay	Chili crisp, sauce bases
Dairy	Cheese, crema, butter brush	Buttermilk dressings, aioli
Eggs	Mayo-based dressings	Fresh pasta, batters
Gluten/Wheat	Croutons, breadcrumbs	Fryer cross-contact, soy sauce
Sesame	Seeds, tahini	Toasted seed mix, buns
Shellfish	Shrimp, oyster sauces	Fish sauce blends
Soy	Tamari, tofu	Marinades, emulsions

Note: For tree nuts, pay special attention to candied nut garnishes and any “crunch” components.

7) What To Do If Something Goes Wrong

- If you see a risk on the plate at the pass:
 - Say “Stop—ALLERGY plate—possible [allergen] present.”
 - Pull the plate from service; hand it to expo. Do not try to pick off garnishes.
 - Expo notifies the station; remake is prioritized.
 - FOH informs the guest that we are remaking the dish to keep them safe.
- If the ticket prints without ALLERGY on top:
 - Do not send it down the line. Reprint or rewrite clearly, then hand to expo.

- Notify a manager and the POS lead to check the printer format.
- If the guest adds an allergy after ordering:
 - Void and re-ring with ALLERGY properly flagged; verbally call to expo.
 - Confirm remake; do not modify the existing plate at the pass or table.

8) FOH-BOH Communication Flow

- Host to server: Note allergy on the handoff and in seating notes when known.
- Server to expo: Verbal call plus physical chit handoff on every ALLERGY order.
- Expo to stations: Read the allergy out loud; confirm understanding with garde manger or relevant station.
- Runner to server at window: "ALLERGY—[allergen]—this plate is for Table [#]."
- Server at table: "This is your [item], prepared with your tree-nut allergy in mind."

9) Root Cause and Corrective Actions (Original, unedited)

- Root cause: the modifier printed on a second line and was missed at garde manger.
- Fix: POS modifier moved to the top line in bold; allergen SOP refresher at pre-shift.

10) Verification and Training

- Pre-shift: Quick allergen SOP refresher led by expo or the shift lead; review any menu changes that affect allergens.
- Shadow checks: New FOH staff complete two observed ALLERGY orders with expo sign-off.
- Spot audits: Managers pull random chits to confirm ALLERGY prints on the top line in bold.
- Feedback loop: Expo logs any catches; FOH reviews at the next pre-shift to prevent repeats.

11) Service Tips to Prevent Near-Misses

- Slow down on ALLERGY entries; deliberate beats fast.
- Never assume a garnish is "safe." Ask if unsure.
- Keep the pass uncluttered; allergy plates need a clean, obvious landing zone.
- Speak in clear, loud, calm calls. ALLERGY calls come first at the pass.